



More complications are introduced by yet another example:

George is on a footbridge over the trolley tracks. He knows trolleys, and can see that the one approaching the bridge is out of control. On the track back of the bridge there are five people; the banks are so steep that they will not be able to get off the track in time. George knows that the only way to stop an out-of-control trolley is to drop a very heavy weight into its path. But the only available, sufficiently heavy weight is a fat man, also watching the trolley from the footbridge. George can shove the fat man onto the track in the path of the trolley, killing the fat man; or he can refrain from doing this, letting the five die.

Many people think that it is not permissible for George to push the fat man. But why is this any different from turning the trolley to kill the one on the right hand section of the trolley tracks? After all, in both cases, you are killing one rather than letting 5 die.

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